



REGISTERING YOUR NAME

You must register your company's name with the appropriate government agency (see pp.212–215), and perhaps at local or state level, too. Depending on the legal form you choose for your business, the name may end in a suffix such as LLC (Limited Liability Corporation) or Inc. (Incorporated). You must also register for corporation tax when you register your business name. Sole proprietors and partnerships are required to register the name of

their businesses only if they choose a “doing business as” name. Whether sole proprietor, partnership, or company, make sure you register a domain name for your business (see pp.114–115). This is the internet address that you will use for your website. While a fee is payable, registering will give you sole use of that address. The domain name does not have to be the same as your business name, but it helps if the two are fairly similar.

! BE AWARE

- **Search national business registers** to see whether your prospective name has already been taken (see pp.212–215). Sole proprietors can consult local website listings.
- **Check trademark registers** and intellectual property office sites (see pp.212–215).
- **Look at domain names**, as you cannot register one that is taken, as well as social media, too.

Descriptive

You might decide on a name for your company after compiling a list of brief descriptors of what your business does. Facebook, WeChat, and Netflix all have names that convey their purpose or function.

Meaningful

A name that has meaning behind it makes for a more compelling brand story. LEGO, for example, comes from the Danish term *leg god*, to “play well.” The name Hotmail arose from HTML, the language used to write web pages.

Unusual

Company names that seem unrelated to the nature of the business may also be highly successful, as they can capture attention. Good examples include online retailer, Amazon, and IT and media giant, Apple.

Alliterative

Using alliteration—starting words with the same sound or letter—makes names fun to say and is another way to make them memorable. Brand names such as Coca-Cola or TikTok, for example, stand out through their alliteration.